

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in an online blog:

Four reasons why doing nothing is not boring at all

For all the wonderful ways that smartphones make life easier and information more accessible, the truth is, we're not programmed to be constantly in "go" mode, and this overstimulation can have a seriously negative impact on our health. My solution? Sitting doing nothing. Taking time to do nothing and letting yourself pause from friends and technology is one of the best things you can do. Here are four reasons to simply do nothing.

1. It Stops Tech Addiction.

Smartphone addiction is a real thing. Spending too much time using technology and social media has been linked to depression and worry, and poor sleep. So the next time you have time to kill, stick your phone in your bag and kill time the old-fashioned way: whether it's daydreaming, doodling, or just sitting around, keep away from that screen.

2. Doing Nothing Can Boost Creativity.

Research has found that daydreaming involves the same processes that govern imagination. So if you're looking to get more creative, do nothing and let the creative juices flow.

3. You Can Discover New Hobbies & Interests.

If you use the extra energy you have saved doing nothing to try a new activity, you'll enjoy your time and learn something, whereas if you're just scrolling through Instagram, you won't really have gained anything.

4. Unplugging & Recharging Can Relieve Stress.

Take some time to unplug and recharge for improved sleep and less stress.

Your principal has asked your group to prepare a talk for the next Parent-Teacher Association meeting on why letting students do nothing can be a good thing. You may want to talk about:

- whether students have enough free time
- the advantages and disadvantages of students doing nothing
- how you will explain to parents the value of letting their children do nothing
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. When do you feel bored?
2. What things do you find boring?
3. What do you do to stop being bored?
4. Do you enjoy doing nothing?
5. Do students have too many activities outside school?
6. Do you find school holidays boring?
7. Do you think it is important to keep busy?
8. Do you think exposure to technology has restricted your imagination?